

TOEFL Speaking Preparation Guide

Structured Questions & High-Score Model Answers

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1 Speaking Practice Set #1

TOEFL ZONE

I'd like to ask you some questions about your health and wellness habits. First, do you have any specific routines or practices you use to maintain your physical well-being? If so, what are they? Yes, I try to maintain my physical health through a simple but consistent routine. I usually walk for at least thirty minutes a day, especially when I feel mentally tired after studying or working. I also try to stretch in the morning because it helps me start the day with more energy. I would not say my routine is very intense, but it is realistic, and that is why I can continue doing it. For me, the most important part of staying healthy is not doing something extreme for a few days, but building habits that I can actually maintain over time. Can you describe any dietary choices or habits that you follow to stay healthy? Give details to extend your answer. I try to follow a balanced diet rather than a very strict one. For example, I usually include vegetables, fruit, and some source of protein in my meals, because they help me stay full and focused during the day. I also try not to skip breakfast, especially when I have a busy schedule, since skipping meals usually makes me tired and less productive. At the same time, I do not completely avoid sweets or fast food, because I think being too restrictive can make a diet hard to maintain. So my main approach is moderation: I try to make healthy choices most of the time, but without putting too much pressure on myself. If you could make one significant change to your diet or exercise routine to stay healthy, what would it be? Why would you make that particular choice? If I could make one major change, I would add regular strength training to my routine. The reason is that walking is helpful for general health, but it does not build enough muscle or improve posture in the same way. Many people only think about exercise in terms of losing weight, but I think strength training is more about long-term health and preventing physical problems later in life. For example, students and office workers often sit for long hours, which can cause back and neck pain. If I developed this habit now, I think I would feel stronger, have better energy, and protect my body in the future. Some people believe that mental health is just as important as physical health, and should be given equal attention. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why? I completely agree that mental health should be treated as equally important as physical health. The main reason is that the two are strongly connected. If someone is constantly stressed, anxious, or emotionally exhausted, it eventually affects their sleep, appetite, concentration, and even their physical energy. For example, a person may have a healthy diet and exercise regularly, but if they are under constant pressure, they may still feel unhealthy. I think in the future, schools and workplaces will pay more attention to mental health because people are becoming more aware of burnout. In my opinion, real wellness means taking care of both the body and the mind.

I'd like to ask you some questions about hobbies. To begin, do you have a hobby or interest that you regularly spend time doing? Yes, one hobby I regularly spend time on is watching movies and series, especially psychological dramas or stories with strong characters. It may sound like simple entertainment, but for me it is a way to relax and also understand different personalities and cultures. When I am busy or stressed, watching something interesting helps me mentally disconnect for a while. I also like discussing movies with friends because people often interpret the same story in very different ways. So this hobby is not only relaxing for me; it also gives me something enjoyable to think and talk about. If you were to select a new hobby, what would you choose and why? If I were to choose a new hobby, I would probably choose photography. The reason is that photography encourages people to notice small details in ordinary places, such as light, colors, people's expressions, or the atmosphere of a street. I think that would be especially useful for someone with a busy lifestyle, because it teaches you to slow down and observe your surroundings. Another reason is that photography can be done almost anywhere, even with a phone. I would not need expensive equipment at the beginning, so it would be a practical hobby to start. Now tell me what might prevent you from starting this new pastime. The biggest thing that might prevent me from starting photography is time. Like many people, I often feel that my schedule is already full, so it can be difficult to add a new activity and do it consistently. Another possible obstacle is perfectionism. Sometimes people hesitate to start a creative hobby because they compare themselves to professionals online and feel their work is not good enough. I think I would have to remind myself that the purpose of a hobby is not to be perfect immediately. It is mainly to enjoy the process and improve gradually. Some people believe it is better to have one interest outside of work or school that you dedicate yourself to rather than multiple smaller ones. What do you think about that and why? I think it depends on the person, but generally I prefer having one main hobby and a few smaller interests. The reason is that one serious hobby gives you a sense of progress. For example, if someone practices photography or music regularly, they can actually see improvement over time, which is very satisfying. However, having only one interest can become limiting, especially when life gets stressful or repetitive. Smaller hobbies give people variety and help them relax in different ways. In the future, I think people will need hobbies even more because work and study are becoming more demanding. Having interests outside of responsibilities can help people maintain balance.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your music preferences. First, how often do you listen to music? Do you listen daily, weekly or less often? I listen to music almost every day, but the amount depends on my mood and schedule. For example, if I am walking, cleaning, or commuting, I usually listen to music because it makes those activities more enjoyable. Sometimes I also listen to soft music while studying, although I prefer instrumental music for that because lyrics can distract me. I would say music is part of my daily routine, but not in a very intense way. It is more like background support that helps me manage my mood and energy throughout the day. What genres or types of music do you usually enjoy listening to? For example, do you prefer classical, rock or jazz music? Give details to explain your answer. I usually enjoy calm and emotional music, especially pop, acoustic songs, and sometimes classical or instrumental music. I like music that creates a particular atmosphere rather than music that is just loud or energetic. For example, when I am studying, I prefer instrumental music because it helps me focus without distracting me with lyrics. But when I am walking or feeling tired, I may listen to pop music because it gives me energy. I think my taste is connected to my emotional state. I do not listen to one genre all the time; I choose music based on what I need at that moment. Can you tell me about a concert or live music event you would like to attend? Why would you make that particular choice? I would love to attend a live concert by an artist whose music I have listened to for many years. The reason is that hearing music live creates a completely different emotional experience compared to listening through headphones. In a concert, you are surrounded by people who know the same songs and feel connected to the same memories. I think that shared atmosphere makes the music more powerful. I would especially choose a concert with meaningful lyrics and a strong live performance, because I would want the experience to feel personal, not just entertaining. Some people believe that music can have a powerful effect on our emotions and moods. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why? I strongly agree that music can affect people's emotions and moods. The main reason is that music is connected to memory. A song can remind someone of a person, a place, or a specific period in their life almost immediately. For example, some songs make me feel calm because I associate them with peaceful moments, while others make me feel motivated when I need energy. I also think music will continue to play an important role in mental health in the future. As people become more stressed, they may use music not only for entertainment but also as a simple way to regulate emotions and feel less alone.

I'd like to ask you some questions about cultural festivals. First, cultural festivals are events that celebrate traditions like food, music, art, or clothing from a certain culture. Yes, I would definitely like to attend a cultural festival, especially one that includes traditional food, music, and local art. I think these festivals are a very enjoyable way to experience a culture directly, instead of only reading about it or watching videos online. Food, clothing, and music can show values and history in a very natural way. For example, a traditional dish may tell you something about the climate, lifestyle, and family traditions of a place. I would go because it would be both educational and enjoyable, and it would help me understand people from different backgrounds better. Have you ever been to one? Or would you like to go to one? Why? Thank you. If you were to go to a cultural festival, what would you like to see or do there? If I went to a cultural festival, I would first want to try the traditional food because food is one of the easiest ways to connect with a culture. I would also like to watch live music or dance performances, since they often show the emotional side of a tradition. Another thing I would enjoy is visiting small booths where artists sell handmade items, such as jewelry, clothing, or pottery. These objects often have stories behind them, and I think that makes the experience more meaningful. I would not want to just take pictures; I would want to ask questions and learn why certain traditions matter. If you were to participate in a cultural festival for your own culture, what would you want to share with other people, and why? If I participated in a festival for my own culture, I would want to share traditional food and music. The reason is that both are very powerful forms of cultural expression. Food can immediately make people curious, and music can create emotion even when people do not understand the language. I would also explain the meaning behind certain traditions, because without context, people may only see the surface. For example, a traditional celebration may look like a simple party, but it may actually represent family unity, respect for elders, or the beginning of a new season. I think sharing that deeper meaning would make the festival more valuable. Some people think cultural festivals are mainly just for fun, while others think that they serve an important purpose, like helping to keep traditions alive. What do you think? I think cultural festivals are fun, but they also serve a much deeper purpose. The main reason is that traditions can disappear if people do not actively practice and share them. A festival gives younger generations a chance to experience their culture in a lively and memorable way. For example, children may not be interested in reading about traditional clothing or music, but if they see people performing, cooking, and celebrating together, they may feel proud of their background. In the future, I think cultural festivals will become even more important because globalization can make cultures look more similar. Festivals can help communities protect their identity while still welcoming others.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with technology in daily life. First, how important is technology in your day-to-day activities? Technology is extremely important in my daily life. I use it for communication, studying, planning, banking, and even simple tasks like checking directions or setting reminders. My phone and laptop are probably the two devices I rely on the most. For example, if I need to manage deadlines, contact someone quickly, or search for information, technology saves a lot of time. At the same time, I try to be aware that relying on it too much can become unhealthy. So I would say technology is necessary for me, but it needs to be used intentionally. Have you ever felt frustrated while using technology? What happened? Yes, I have definitely felt frustrated while using technology, especially when something does not work at the exact moment I need it. For example, I once had an online meeting, and my internet connection became unstable right before I had to speak. It was stressful because the problem was not completely under my control, but it still affected my performance. Another common frustration is when apps update, and suddenly the layout changes, so simple tasks take longer than before. These experiences remind me that technology is helpful, but it is not always reliable. That is why it is useful to have backup plans, especially for important work. Some people believe technology will replace many jobs, while others think it will create more opportunities. What is your opinion and why? I think technology will do both: it will replace some jobs, but it will also create new opportunities. The main reason is that technology usually takes over repetitive tasks first. For example, machines and software can process data, answer basic customer questions, or organize information faster than humans. However, new jobs will appear in areas like artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, digital education, and technical support. The problem is that not everyone will be prepared for this shift. In the future, I think workers who keep learning and adapting will benefit, while those who do not receive training may struggle. So the real issue is not technology itself, but whether society helps people adjust to it. Some people believe that reliance on technology is reducing our ability to think independently and solve problems. Do you agree, or disagree with this belief? Why or why not? I partly agree with this idea. Technology can reduce independent thinking if people use it as a replacement for effort rather than as a tool. For example, if students immediately ask an AI tool or a search engine for every answer, they may stop practicing how to analyze problems on their own. Over time, that could weaken their confidence and creativity. However, I do not think technology is automatically harmful. If people use it to check their ideas, learn faster, or explore different perspectives, it can actually improve problem-solving. In the future, I think the most successful people will be those who combine human judgment with technology, instead of depending on technology blindly.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with commuting. First, what kinds of places do you usually go to during the week, and how do you get there? During a typical week, I usually go to university, grocery stores, and sometimes a café or library to study. I mostly use public transportation or walk, depending on the distance and weather. If the place is nearby, I prefer walking because it helps me clear my mind and get some light exercise. For longer distances, I use the bus because it is cheaper and more convenient than driving. I do not always enjoy waiting for transportation, especially when I am in a hurry, but overall it works well for my daily routine. Can you describe how someone in your family or a friend usually travels to work or school? How much time does it take, and what transportation does the person use? One of my friends usually travels to university by bus. Her commute takes about twenty to thirty minutes, depending on traffic and the bus schedule. She prefers taking the bus because parking near campus is expensive and sometimes hard to find. Also, she can use the time on the bus to check messages, review notes, or just relax before class. The only problem is that if the bus is delayed, she has to leave home much earlier to avoid being late. So it is convenient in many ways, but it also requires some planning. Some people believe that living close to work or school improves quality of life, while others think location doesn't matter much. What do you think and why? I think living close to work or school can significantly improve quality of life. The main reason is that commuting takes not only time, but also energy. If someone spends one or two hours every day traveling, they may have less time for sleep, exercise, cooking, or spending time with family. For example, a student who lives near campus can attend classes more easily, use the library, and participate in activities without constantly worrying about transportation. Of course, location is not the only factor in life, but I think it has a strong effect on daily stress and productivity. Some people believe that employers should reimburse employees for their commuting costs, while others think that employees should pay for their own travel to work. Which view do you agree with and why? I think employers should at least partially reimburse commuting costs, especially when employees are required to work in person. The reason is that commuting is directly connected to the job. If a company expects workers to come to the office every day, transportation becomes part of the cost of doing that work. This support could also make employees feel more valued and reduce financial pressure, especially for people with lower salaries. However, I do not think companies must pay for every personal choice, such as someone choosing to live very far away. A fair approach would be a standard transportation allowance.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your personal finance habits. First, how often do you review your money management habits, such as tracking your expenses or budgeting? Do you do this weekly, monthly or less than? I try to review my money habits at least once a month. I do not track every small purchase every day, because that can become stressful, but I like to have a general idea of where my money is going. For example, I usually check how much I spent on food, transportation, and unnecessary items. This helps me notice patterns. Sometimes I realize that small purchases, like coffee or snacks, add up more than I expected. Reviewing my spending monthly helps me make better decisions without feeling too restricted. Can you describe one or two methods you or someone you know uses to manage their finances. For example, do you use budgeting apps or keep a written record? One method I use is separating my expenses into categories, such as rent, food, transportation, and personal spending. This helps me see which areas are necessary and which ones can be reduced. I also know people who use budgeting apps, and I think those can be very helpful because they automatically show spending patterns. Personally, I prefer a simple spreadsheet or notes on my phone because it feels more flexible. The important thing is not the tool itself, but whether it helps you become more aware of your habits. Can you describe a financial goal you have achieved recently. What motivated you to achieve this goal? One financial goal I achieved recently was saving money for an important personal expense instead of using credit or borrowing from someone. I was motivated by the feeling of independence. When you save gradually for something, even if it takes time, you feel more in control of your life. To achieve it, I reduced some unnecessary spending, especially eating out and buying things I did not really need. It was not always easy, but it taught me that small decisions can make a big difference over time. The result was satisfying because I reached the goal without creating extra financial stress. Some people believe that fiscal responsibility education should be mandatory in schools to help students manage their finances effectively as adults. Do you agree or disagree with this idea? Why? I strongly agree that financial responsibility should be taught in schools. Many students graduate with knowledge of academic subjects, but they may not know how to budget, save money, understand credit, or avoid debt. These are practical skills that affect everyone's adult life. For example, a person who understands interest rates and monthly payments is less likely to make careless financial decisions. I think this type of education should be simple and realistic, not too theoretical. Schools could teach students how to create a budget, compare prices, and plan for emergencies. That would make them more prepared for real life.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your use of public transportation. First, how often do you use public transportation, like buses or trains? Give details to explain your answer. use public transportation fairly often, especially when I need to go somewhere that is not within walking distance. I usually take the bus because it is affordable and convenient for daily trips. I do not use it for every single journey, because sometimes walking is easier or faster for short distances. But when I go to university, shopping centers, or appointments, public transportation is usually my first choice. I like that I do not have to worry about parking or fuel costs, although I sometimes have to plan around the bus schedule. Can you describe any benefits or disadvantages you might experience from using public transportation. The main benefit of public transportation is that it is cheaper and less stressful than driving. I can sit, listen to music, read something, or simply relax instead of focusing on traffic. It is also better for the environment because one bus can carry many people at the same time. However, there are some disadvantages. Public transportation can be unreliable if buses are delayed or if the schedule is limited. It can also be uncomfortable when it is crowded. So I think it is a useful system, but it needs to be frequent, clean, and reliable to really work well. Would you consider moving in order to have better access to public transportation. Why or why not? Yes, I would consider moving if better public transportation made my daily life easier. The reason is that transportation affects almost everything: how much time you spend commuting, how much money you spend, and how tired you feel during the day. If I lived near a reliable bus stop or train station, I would probably feel more independent and less dependent on driving or asking others for rides. However, I would also consider other factors, such as rent, safety, and distance from work or school. So I would not move only for transportation, but it would definitely be an important factor. Some people believe that cities should invest more in public transportation to reduce traffic congestion, commuting time and pollution. Do you agree or disagree with this idea? Why? I agree that cities should invest more in public transportation. The main reason is that good public transportation benefits not only the people who use it, but the whole city. If buses and trains are reliable, more people may choose them instead of driving, which can reduce traffic and pollution. It can also help people who cannot afford a car or who do not want to drive every day. For example, students, older people, and low-income workers often depend on public transportation. I think it is one of the most practical ways to make cities more equal, cleaner, and easier to live in.

Same as No.8

I'd like to ask you some questions about learning new hobbies. First, what kinds of hobbies do your friends or family have? Why do you think they enjoy these hobbies? My friends and family have different kinds of hobbies. Some of them enjoy cooking, some like watching movies, and others prefer outdoor activities like walking or hiking. I think they enjoy these hobbies because each one gives them a different kind of relief from daily stress. For example, cooking can feel creative and comforting, especially when people make food for their family. Outdoor activities help people feel more energetic and less trapped inside. Watching movies, on the other hand, gives people a chance to relax and escape from their routine for a while. Now, if your school or workplace were to organize after-work hobby clubs, which clubs do you think would interest the most people? I think the most popular clubs would probably be fitness, cooking, photography, and language clubs. These activities are practical and social at the same time. For example, a fitness club would attract people who want to stay healthy but need motivation from others. A cooking club would be enjoyable because people could learn useful skills and share food together. Photography would also interest many people because almost everyone has a phone and can participate without expensive equipment. I think people are more likely to join hobby clubs when the activity feels useful, affordable, and easy to start. Do you think hobbies should mostly be relaxing, or is it better if they challenge you? Why? I think the best hobbies should be both relaxing and a little challenging. If a hobby is only relaxing, it may become boring after a while. But if it is too difficult, people may feel pressured and stop enjoying it. A good hobby should give you a break from responsibilities while also helping you improve in some way. For example, learning photography can be relaxing because you walk around and notice beautiful details, but it is also challenging because you learn about light, composition, and timing. That balance makes the hobby more satisfying. How important do you think it is for people to keep exploring new hobbies as they grow older? Why? I think it is very important for people to keep exploring new hobbies as they grow older. The reason is that hobbies help people stay curious, active, and socially connected. When people repeat the same routine for years, life can become predictable and even emotionally tiring. A new hobby gives them something fresh to learn and look forward to. It can also help older people meet others and maintain confidence. For example, someone who joins a painting or walking group may not only learn a skill but also build friendships. So hobbies are not just entertainment; they support personal growth and well-being.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your online learning experiences. First, have you or someone you know ever taken an online course? If so, what was the subject? Yes, I have taken online courses before, mostly related to academic writing and technical skills. For example, I once used online materials to improve my writing structure and learn how to organize ideas more clearly. I liked the flexibility because I could review the lessons whenever I had time. I also know people who have taken online language courses or programming courses. I think online learning is especially useful when the subject requires repeated practice, because you can pause, review, and go back to difficult parts as many times as needed. Can you describe what you think are some of the advantages or disadvantages of an online course over an in-person course? The biggest advantage of an online course is flexibility. Students can study from home, save commuting time, and review recorded lessons if they do not understand something the first time. This is especially helpful for people who work or have family responsibilities. However, the main disadvantage is that online courses can feel less personal. In an in-person class, it is easier to ask spontaneous questions, talk to classmates, and stay motivated because there is a real classroom atmosphere. So I think online learning is convenient, but it requires more self-discipline than face-to-face learning. Online courses often let students work at their own pace. How do you feel about learning when there is no set class time? I have mixed feelings about learning without a set class time. On one hand, I really appreciate the flexibility because I can study when I feel most focused. For example, some people learn better early in the morning, while others prefer studying late at night. On the other hand, when there is no fixed schedule, it is easy to postpone lessons and fall behind. I think this type of learning works best for students who are organized and motivated. Personally, I would prefer a flexible course that still has weekly deadlines, because that gives freedom without losing structure. One of the concerns with online learning is online assessment, with some people believing that you cannot trust the results of an online test, what do you think about that issue? I think that concern is reasonable, but it does not mean online assessment is completely unreliable. The main problem is that it can be harder to make sure students are completing the test honestly. For example, some students may use outside help or search for answers during the exam. However, online tests can be improved through time limits, oral explanations, project-based assignments, or questions that require personal analysis rather than memorized answers. In my opinion, online assessment should not depend only on multiple-choice exams. If teachers use a combination of methods, the results can be much more trustworthy.

Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about your spending habits. First, can you tell me about a recent purchase you or someone in your family made and why you decided to buy it. A recent purchase I made was a pair of comfortable shoes. I decided to buy them because I walk a lot during the week, and my old shoes were starting to hurt my feet. At first, I hesitated because they were a little more expensive than I expected, but I realized that comfort and quality were more important in this case. Since I use them almost every day, I saw it as a practical purchase rather than just something fashionable. I think some purchases are worth paying more for when they improve your daily life. When you make a purchase, do you usually plan ahead, or do you buy things spontaneously? Why? I usually try to plan ahead, especially for expensive items. The reason is that planning helps me avoid regret. If I buy something spontaneously, I may later realize that I did not really need it or that I could have found a better option. For example, before buying electronics or clothing, I usually compare prices and read reviews. However, for small things like snacks or coffee, I may be more spontaneous. Overall, I prefer planned spending because it helps me feel more in control of my money. Some people believe that creating a monthly or weekly budget is essential for managing finances effectively. When budgeting your time or money next purchase, which is more important. Quality for the money or spending less overall? Why? I think quality for the money is more important than simply spending less. The reason is that the cheapest option is not always the most economical in the long run. For example, if I buy a very cheap backpack and it breaks after a few months, I will need to replace it, so I may end up spending more. A better-quality product may cost more at first, but it can last longer and perform better. Of course, this does not mean people should always buy expensive things. It means they should look for value, not just the lowest price. For my final question, I'd like to ask about using apps or online tools for managing spending habits. Do you think people will increasingly rely on financial apps and tools to manage their money? Or will people prefer to hire personal financial managers? Explain your thoughts. I think most people will increasingly rely on financial apps and online tools, mainly because they are convenient and affordable. A personal financial manager may be useful for wealthy people or for complicated financial decisions, but for ordinary daily spending, an app is usually enough. For example, apps can track expenses, show spending categories, and send reminders when someone is close to their budget limit. However, I do not think apps will completely replace human advice. For major decisions, like investing or buying a house, people may still want professional guidance. So I think apps will handle everyday money management, while experts will help with more serious financial planning.

I'd like to learn about your experience. with books and reading? Was there a time in your life when you read more or less than you do now? What changed? Yes, there was a time when I read more than I do now, especially when I had fewer academic and work responsibilities. I used to read more novels and general-interest books just for pleasure. Now, I still read, but much of my reading is connected to study, research, or practical information. What changed is mainly my schedule and priorities. When life becomes busier, reading for pleasure is often the first thing people reduce. I would like to return to it more regularly, because reading helps me slow down and think more deeply. In your opinion, is reading for pleasure a popular way people spend their free time where you live? Why do you think that is? I would say reading for pleasure is not as popular as it used to be, especially among younger people. Many people now spend their free time on social media, short videos, or streaming platforms because those activities require less effort and give quick entertainment. Reading, on the other hand, needs more concentration and patience. However, I do think there are still people who enjoy books, especially those who see reading as a way to relax or learn. So it is not unpopular, but it has more competition than before. Do you think reading different types of books helps people understand each other and get along better? Why or why not? Yes, I think reading different types of books can help people understand each other better. Books allow us to see the world through someone else's experience, especially when the characters come from different cultures, social classes, or historical periods. For example, a novel about migration or poverty can make readers more empathetic because they are not just learning facts; they are emotionally following someone's life. Nonfiction books can also help by explaining social problems in a deeper way. Reading does not automatically make everyone kinder, but it can broaden people's perspective and reduce quick judgment. I just have one more question. Looking ahead, some people believe that future generations will read less than today's generation. Do you agree or disagree? Why? I partly agree that future generations may read fewer traditional books, but I do not think reading itself will disappear. The main reason is that younger people are growing up with digital media, so they may prefer shorter texts, audiobooks, e-books, or interactive formats instead of printed novels. However, people will still need reading skills for education, work, and communication. I think the form of reading will change more than the habit itself. The real challenge is attention span. If schools and families encourage deep reading from an early age, future generations can still develop strong reading habits, even in a digital world.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your daily routines. First, do you usually follow a strict daily routine or is your routine flexible? My routine is somewhat flexible, although I do try to keep a few stable habits. For example, I usually have certain times for studying, eating, and sleeping, but I do not plan every hour of the day. I prefer this balance because a completely strict routine can become stressful when unexpected things happen. At the same time, having no routine at all makes me feel disorganized. So I try to keep the important parts consistent while leaving some space for changes. Now, can you describe a typical day for you? What are some activities you typically do in the morning or in the evening? On a typical day, I usually start by checking my schedule and deciding what tasks are most important. In the morning, I try to do work that requires more concentration, such as studying, writing, or preparing assignments, because my mind is fresher. During the day, I may go to class, work on projects, or run errands. In the evening, I prefer to slow down a little. I might cook, call my family, watch something, or review what I need to do the next day. Having this general rhythm helps me feel more organized. And how do you manage changes in your daily routine? Can you share an example of a time when you had to adjust your plans. When my routine changes, I try to identify what is urgent and what can be postponed. For example, there was a time when I planned to spend the evening studying, but an unexpected personal responsibility came up. Instead of trying to do everything at once, I moved the less urgent tasks to the next day and focused on the most important deadline. I think the key is not to panic when plans change. If you stay calm and reorganize your priorities, you can usually handle the situation without losing too much progress. Last question. Some people believe that having a strict daily routine helps them be more productive and organized, while others think that flexibility is key to handling life's unpredictability. Which approach do you think is more effective? And why? I think a flexible routine is more effective than a very strict one. The reason is that real life is unpredictable, and people need room to adjust without feeling like they have failed. A strict routine can be useful for building discipline, but if it is too rigid, even a small change can create stress. For example, if someone misses one planned task, they may feel the whole day is ruined. A flexible routine allows people to stay organized while still adapting to unexpected events. In my opinion, the best approach is to have clear priorities, not a perfect schedule.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with friendship. First, do you have a large group of friends? Or do you prefer to have a smaller group of friends? I prefer having a smaller group of close friends. I enjoy meeting new people, but when it comes to real friendship, I value depth more than numbers. With a smaller group, it is easier to stay connected, have honest conversations, and support each other during difficult times. A large group can be fun for social events, but it does not always mean the relationships are meaningful. For me, friendship is about trust and consistency, so I would rather have a few reliable friends than many casual ones. Now, describe a time when a friendship taught you something valuable or helped you see something from a new perspective. One friendship that taught me a lot was with someone who had a very different personality from mine. I tend to think carefully before making decisions, but this friend was more spontaneous and confident. At first, I sometimes thought she was careless, but over time I realized she was simply less afraid of making mistakes. That helped me see that not every decision has to be perfect. Sometimes taking action is better than overthinking. This friendship taught me to be more open-minded and to appreciate different ways of approaching life. In your opinion, what makes a friendship last long time? I think long-lasting friendship depends mainly on trust, communication, and mutual respect. People change over time, so a friendship cannot survive only because two people used to be close in the past. They need to keep making an effort to understand each other. For example, friends may become busy with work, study, or family, but even small messages or honest conversations can keep the relationship alive. I also think forgiveness matters because misunderstandings happen in any close relationship. A friendship lasts when both people care enough to repair problems instead of walking away immediately. Some people believe that maintaining friendships is essential for emotional well-being and life satisfaction. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why or why not? I agree that maintaining friendships is essential for emotional well-being. The main reason is that friends provide a kind of support that is different from family or professional relationships. With close friends, people can often speak more freely, share worries, and feel understood without being judged. This can reduce loneliness and make difficult periods easier to handle. For example, even one honest conversation with a trusted friend can change someone's mood and help them think more clearly. Of course, people also need independence, but I think meaningful friendships make life emotionally richer and more balanced.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your music preferences. First, how often do you listen to music? Do you listen daily, weekly or less often? I listen to music almost every day, but usually in short periods rather than for many hours. For example, I often listen to music when I am walking, cleaning, or taking a break after studying. It helps me change my mood and create a more pleasant atmosphere. I do not always listen while doing serious work because lyrics can distract me, but instrumental music can sometimes help me focus. So music is not just entertainment for me; it is also a way to manage my energy during the day. What genres or types of music do you usually enjoy listening to? For example, do you prefer classical, rock or jazz music? Give details to explain your answer. I usually enjoy soft pop, acoustic music, and sometimes classical or instrumental music. I prefer music that has a clear emotional feeling, because I often choose songs based on my mood. For example, if I feel tired, I may listen to calm music to relax. If I need energy, I choose something more rhythmic. I also like instrumental music when I need to concentrate because it creates background atmosphere without interrupting my thoughts. So I would not say I have only one favorite genre. My preference depends on the situation and what I need at that moment. Can you tell me about a concert or live music event you would like to attend? Why would you make that particular choice? I would like to attend a live concert by an artist whose songs I have listened to for many years. The reason is that live music feels much more powerful than listening alone through headphones. In a concert, the audience shares the same emotions, sings together, and reacts to the performance in real time. I think that atmosphere can make familiar songs feel new again. I would choose a concert with meaningful lyrics and strong vocals, not just loud music, because I would want the experience to feel emotional and memorable. Some people believe that music can have a powerful effect on our emotions and moods. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why? I definitely agree that music can strongly affect our emotions and moods. The main reason is that music is connected to memory. A single song can remind someone of a particular person, place, or period of life. For example, some songs make people feel nostalgic, while others make them feel calm or motivated. Music can also help people process emotions that are difficult to express in words. That is why many people listen to different types of music depending on whether they are happy, stressed, or tired. In my opinion, music is powerful because it speaks to people emotionally, not just intellectually.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your participation in sports. First, do you currently play any sports or engage regularly in any physical activities? I do not play a competitive sport regularly, but I try to stay physically active through walking and light exercise. For me, the goal is not competition; it is mainly to stay healthy and reduce stress. Walking is easy to fit into my daily routine because I can do it almost anywhere and I do not need special equipment. I also like it because it helps me clear my mind after a long day. I think simple physical activities can be very effective if people do them consistently. If you were able to, what sport that you do not currently play would you like to be really good at? Why that particular sport? If I could become really good at one sport, I would choose swimming. The main reason is that swimming is good for the whole body, but it is also gentle on the joints. Unlike some sports that can put pressure on the knees or back, swimming allows people to exercise without too much impact. I also think it is a useful life skill, not just a sport. Being confident in water can be important for safety. Another reason is that swimming seems mentally relaxing because the movement and breathing are very rhythmic. Tell me about an experience you had while playing a sport or engaging in a physical activity that you remember well. What made it memorable? One physical activity I remember well was a long walk I took with a friend during a stressful period. It was not a formal sport, but it had a strong effect on me. We walked for more than an hour and talked about our studies, plans, and worries. What made it memorable was that I felt much lighter afterward, even though nothing had magically changed. It reminded me that physical movement can improve mental clarity. Sometimes when people feel stuck, even a simple activity like walking can help them think more calmly. Some people believe that children should not participate in contact sports like rugby or hockey, because they could get hurt, while others believe that these sports teach awareness and teamwork. What do you think and why? I think children can participate in contact sports, but only with proper safety rules, training, and supervision. I understand the concern because injuries can happen, especially when children are not taught the correct techniques. However, completely banning these sports may not be necessary. Contact sports can teach children teamwork, discipline, body awareness, and how to handle pressure. The key is to make the environment safe. For example, coaches should focus on technique rather than aggression, and children should use proper protective equipment. So I would support participation, but not careless participation.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your entertainment preferences. What kind of movies do your family or friends generally like to watch? For example, do they prefer action movies, comedies, dramas, or other types? My family and friends have different tastes, but many of them enjoy dramas, comedies, and action movies. Some prefer comedies because they want to relax and laugh after a long day. Others like dramas because they enjoy emotional stories and realistic characters. Personally, I am more interested in movies with strong storytelling and psychological depth. I like films that make me think about people's choices and motivations. So in my circle, movies are not only a way to pass time; they are also something we sometimes discuss afterward. When you watch a movie, do you prefer to watch a movie after work or school on weekdays? Or do you like to watch during the weekends? Why? I prefer watching movies during the weekend because I can enjoy them without feeling rushed or guilty. On weekdays, I usually have tasks, deadlines, or responsibilities on my mind, so even if I watch something, I may not fully relax. During the weekend, I can choose a longer movie, make tea or snacks, and really pay attention to the story. I think entertainment is more enjoyable when people are mentally present. For that reason, weekends are better for me, especially if the movie is serious or emotionally complex. Next, I'd like to get your opinion. In the past, people mostly watched movies and theaters. Today, many people watch movies at home. Do you think that movie theaters will continue to exist in the future? Why or why not? Yes, I think movie theaters will continue to exist, but their role may become more limited and special. The reason is that watching movies at home is cheaper and more convenient, so people may not go to theaters for ordinary films as often as before. However, theaters still offer a unique experience: a large screen, strong sound, and a shared atmosphere with other viewers. For example, action movies, major releases, or visually impressive films feel different in a theater. So I do not think theaters will disappear, but they may become places for special events rather than regular movie watching. I just have one more question. Some people believe that movies can be a powerful tool for educating people and raising awareness about important issues. Do you agree with this idea? Or do you think there are other more effective ways to educate people? Explain why you think so. I agree that movies can be a powerful tool for education and awareness. The main reason is that movies combine information with emotion. When people read statistics about poverty, discrimination, or environmental problems, they may understand the issue intellectually, but a film can help them feel it personally. For example, a movie about refugees can show the fear, loss, and hope behind the headlines. Of course, movies should not replace formal education or serious research, because they can sometimes simplify complex topics. But they are very effective for making people care about issues they might otherwise ignore.

stions about your experiences with setting personal goals. First, think of a time, recent or not, when you had something you wanted to achieve. What was it? One goal I wanted to achieve was improving my English speaking ability. It was important to me because English is connected to education, communication, and future opportunities. At first, I understood a lot when listening or reading, but speaking fluently was more difficult. To work on this goal, I practiced answering questions aloud, recorded myself, and tried to notice repeated mistakes. It was not a quick process, but I gradually became more comfortable expressing my ideas. This goal mattered because it gave me more confidence in academic and professional situations. In general, how do you handle difficulties or obstacles, that come up while working toward what you want to achieve. When I face obstacles, I try to break the problem into smaller parts instead of seeing it as one big failure. For example, if I am not improving in a skill, I ask myself whether the problem is lack of time, weak strategy, or not enough feedback. Then I adjust one thing at a time. I also try not to depend only on motivation, because motivation changes from day to day. A routine is more reliable. This approach helps me continue even when progress feels slow. In your opinion, how important is goal setting for personal growth? I think goal setting is very important for personal growth because it gives people direction. Without goals, it is easy to stay busy but not actually move forward. A clear goal helps people decide what to prioritize and what to ignore. For example, if someone wants to improve their health, they can make specific choices about exercise, diet, and sleep instead of just hoping to feel better. Goals also help people measure progress, which can be motivating. However, goals should be realistic; otherwise, they can create stress rather than growth. Last question. Do you think children should be taught to set personal goals from an early age? Why or why not? Yes, I think children should be taught to set personal goals, but in a healthy and age-appropriate way. The reason is that goal setting teaches responsibility, patience, and self-confidence. For example, a child might set a simple goal like reading a book, learning a song, or improving in a sport. When they achieve it, they learn that effort can lead to progress. However, adults should not turn goal setting into constant pressure or competition. Children should learn that goals are tools for growth, not reasons to feel like failures. If taught carefully, this skill can help them throughout life.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your experiences with commuting. First, what kinds of places do you usually go to during the week? And how do you get there? Can you describe how someone in your family or a friend usually travels to work or school? How much time does it take and what transportation does the person use? Some people believe that living close to work or school improves quality of life, while others think location doesn't matter much. What do you think? And why? Some people believe that employers should reimburse employees for their commuting costs, while others think that employees should pay for their own travel to work. Which view do you agree with, and why?

I'd like to ask you some questions about your job satisfaction. First, what do you think are the most important things to consider when looking for a job? I think the most important things to consider are the work environment, opportunities for growth, salary, and work-life balance. Salary matters because people need financial stability, but it should not be the only factor. If the workplace is toxic or there is no chance to learn, even a high salary may not make someone satisfied. I would also consider whether the job matches my long-term goals. A good job should allow people to use their abilities, develop new skills, and still have enough time and energy for their personal life. Now, can you describe a job that either you or one of your friends has had? What kind of work was involved? One of my friends worked part-time at a café while studying. Her job involved taking orders, preparing drinks, cleaning tables, and dealing with customers during busy hours. It sounded simple at first, but she told me it required patience, speed, and good communication skills. Sometimes customers were impatient or changed their orders several times, so she had to stay calm and polite. I think that kind of job teaches practical skills that people do not always learn in school, especially responsibility and how to handle pressure. What kinds of things do you think can lead people to feel unhappy in their work? Can you tell me about one or two of them? I think people often feel unhappy at work when they feel unappreciated or when the workload is unreasonable. If employees work hard but never receive feedback, respect, or recognition, they may lose motivation. Another major reason is lack of control. For example, if someone has no flexibility, no chance to make decisions, and no opportunity to grow, the job can feel meaningless. Workplace relationships also matter. Even an interesting job can become stressful if the environment is full of conflict or poor communication. Some people believe that working for a large company offers more advantages than working for a small company, while others prefer the opposite. What do you think? And why? I think both have advantages, but I would prefer working for a smaller company at the beginning of my career. The reason is that small companies often give employees broader responsibilities, so they can learn faster. In a large company, roles may be more specialized, and employees might only handle one narrow part of a project. A small company can also feel more personal because communication is usually more direct. However, large companies may offer better salaries, benefits, and stability. So it depends on someone's priorities, but for learning and growth, I think a smaller company can be a very good environment.

Today I'd like to ask you some questions about your education experiences. First, which do you think is more important for a college, offering a wide variety of courses or having small class sizes? Why? I think small class sizes are more important, especially for the quality of learning. A wide variety of courses is useful, but if classes are too large, students may not receive enough attention or feedback. In a smaller class, students can ask questions more easily, participate in discussions, and build stronger relationships with instructors. For example, when a professor knows the students better, they can understand their weaknesses and guide them more effectively. So while course variety is attractive, I believe small classes create a better learning environment. Imagine that you are preparing for a test. Would you prefer to study by yourself or in a group? What would make you choose one over the other? I usually prefer to study by myself first and then review with a group later. The reason is that I need quiet time to understand the material at my own pace. If I join a group too early, I may become distracted or depend too much on other people's explanations. However, after I have studied the basics, group study can be very helpful. Other students may notice points I missed, and explaining ideas to them helps me test my own understanding. So I think individual study is better for learning, while group study is better for review. Some people believe that online courses offer more flexibility and accessibility compared to those offered in general classroom settings and are therefore superior? What are your thoughts on this? Do you agree or disagree? Why? I agree that online courses offer more flexibility and accessibility, but I do not think they are always superior. They are excellent for students who work, live far from campus, or need to study at their own pace. For example, recorded lectures allow students to review difficult topics several times. However, in-person classes offer direct interaction, immediate feedback, and a stronger sense of community. Some students also stay more motivated when they physically attend class. So I think online courses are very useful, but whether they are better depends on the subject, the student, and the quality of the course design. Lastly, online courses are becoming increasingly popular and there are now full degree programs offered by universities where every class is available online only. Do you think online learning will someday completely replace in-person learning? Explain your thoughts. No, I do not think online learning will completely replace in-person learning. It will probably become more common, but some parts of education are difficult to move fully online. For example, laboratory work, clinical training, studio courses, and discussion-based classes often require direct interaction and hands-on practice. In-person learning also helps students build social and communication skills, which are important for professional life. However, I do think many universities will use a hybrid model, combining online lectures with face-to-face activities. That approach gives students flexibility while still preserving the benefits of real classroom interaction.

Now, I'd like you to think back to the last time you visited a city in your country—a city that you didn't live in. Why did you travel to that city? What did you like about that city? The last city I visited was mainly for a short trip, not for living or studying. I went there because I wanted to see a different environment and spend some time away from my normal routine. What I liked most was the energy of the city. There were many cafés, shops, historical places, and people from different backgrounds. I also enjoyed walking through the busy streets because it made the city feel alive. Even though it was crowded, I liked the variety of things to do. It reminded me that visiting a city can be refreshing because you can experience culture, food, and daily life in a concentrated way. Cities affect people in different ways. Some people find cities dynamic and exciting. Others find that cities are overwhelming and drain them of energy. What kind of reaction do you have to cities? Why do you think you react in this way? I usually find cities exciting, but only for a limited amount of time. I like the energy, the variety of people, and the feeling that something is always happening. Cities give me access to more restaurants, events, public transportation, and professional opportunities. However, after a while, the noise, traffic, and crowds can become exhausting. I think I react this way because I enjoy stimulation and diversity, but I also need quiet time to recharge. So for me, cities are inspiring places to visit or work in, but I would need a calm home environment to feel balanced. Next, I'd like to ask your opinion. Some people believe that those who live in cities lead more interesting lives. They would argue, for example, that people who live in cities have more access to professional opportunities and interesting leisure activities. Do you agree that people who live in cities lead more interesting lives? Why or why not? I partly agree with this idea. City life can be more interesting because people have easier access to universities, jobs, cultural events, restaurants, and public services. For example, someone who lives in a large city may attend lectures, concerts, exhibitions, or professional networking events without traveling far. That can make daily life feel more active and diverse. However, I do not think an interesting life depends only on location. People in smaller towns can also have meaningful lives if they have strong relationships, hobbies, and a clear sense of purpose. So cities create more opportunities, but people still need to use those opportunities actively. For some time now, researchers have been interested in whether green spaces, such as parks, make people who live in cities happier. Do you think that city governments should create more parks in urban areas to promote a general sense of happiness and life satisfaction? Why or why not? Yes, I strongly think city governments should create more parks and green spaces. The main reason is that urban life can be stressful, and people need places where they can relax without spending money. Parks give residents space to walk, exercise, meet friends, or simply sit quietly away from traffic and noise. They are also important for children and older people, who may not have many safe outdoor areas. In addition, green spaces can improve air quality and make neighborhoods more attractive. So parks are not just decorative; they are part of public health and quality of life.

Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about your commuting habits. First, is it important to live close to your school or work? Why? Imagine that you could choose to commute by car, which is faster but more expensive, or by public transportation, which is slower but less expensive. Which would you choose, and why? Some people believe that commuting can be stressful and tiring. What do you think are one or two different ways to make commuting more enjoyable? Give reasons for your answer. Lastly, considering advances in technology, some people believe that commuting might disappear entirely. How do you think a severe decline in commuting might affect businesses in positive ways and negative ways? Please give one example of each.

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Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about your work-life balance. First, can you share one or two strategies that you use that you think are effective in managing your work-life balance? One strategy I use is setting priorities at the beginning of the day. Instead of trying to finish everything, I choose the two or three tasks that matter most. This helps me avoid feeling overwhelmed. Another strategy is creating small boundaries between work and personal time. For example, when I finish studying or working, I try to take a walk, cook, or talk to family instead of continuing to check messages. I think work-life balance does not mean having equal hours for everything. It means having enough structure so that work does not completely take over your health and personal life. Many companies are now developing programs to help employees manage work-life balance. Would programs like this affect your interest in working for a particular company? Why or why not? Yes, programs like that would definitely affect my interest in a company. The reason is that they show the company understands employees are human beings, not just workers. For example, if a company offers flexible hours, mental health support, or realistic workload expectations, I would assume it cares about long-term productivity rather than only short-term output. This would make me more loyal and motivated. Of course, salary and career growth are still important, but a supportive work environment can make a huge difference in daily life. I would rather work for a company that protects employees from burnout than one that only offers a high salary. Some companies also offer flexible working hours or remote work options to help employees achieve a better work-life balance, but they are concerned that these options would reduce employee attention to tasks or engagement in the workplace. Do you think such programs are a good strategy for companies? Why or why not? I think flexible hours and remote work can be a good strategy if they are managed properly. The main reason is that flexibility often increases trust and motivation. When employees can control part of their schedule, they may work with more focus because they feel respected. For example, some people are more productive early in the morning, while others concentrate better later in the day. However, companies still need clear expectations, deadlines, and communication systems. Flexibility should not mean lack of responsibility. If there are measurable goals and regular check-ins, these programs can improve both employee well-being and company performance. Lastly, looking to the future, do you think people's attitudes towards work-life balance will change? For example, do you think people will prioritize personal life over work, or work over personal life? Explain your thoughts. Yes, I think attitudes toward work-life balance will continue to change. More people will probably prioritize personal well-being, or at least they will expect work to fit better into a healthy life. One reason is that many workers have experienced burnout, especially in demanding jobs where they are always connected through phones and emails. Another reason is that younger generations often value flexibility and mental health more openly than previous generations. However, I do not think work will become unimportant. People still need financial stability and professional purpose. I think the main shift will be toward balance: people will want meaningful work, but not at the cost of their health.

Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about your exercise habits. First, can you describe the type of exercise you or someone you know typically does regularly, such as running, yoga, or weightlifting? Why? Some exercise programs are done alone, and some are designed to be done with others. Would you prefer to exercise alone, or would you prefer to exercise with others? Why? Some people believe that exercising outdoors is both more beneficial and more enjoyable than exercising indoors. Do you agree or disagree and why? Lastly, I would like to ask about using fitness apps. Some people like to use fitness apps on smart phones to organize their fitness schedules. Do you agree this is a good way to keep track of your exercising goals? Why or why not?

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Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about how you use social media. First, if you were to choose a social media platform to use most regularly, which one would you choose, and why? If I had to choose one social media platform to use most regularly, I would probably choose Instagram. The reason is that it combines different types of content, such as photos, short videos, messages, and educational pages. I use it not only for entertainment, but also to follow accounts related to language learning, academic life, and personal interests. It is also a convenient way to stay connected with friends. However, I try to be careful because it is easy to spend too much time scrolling without noticing. So I like the platform, but I think it needs to be used with some self-control. Do you think social media is more beneficial for younger people or older people? Why? I think social media can benefit both groups, but in different ways. For younger people, it can be useful for learning, networking, finding opportunities, and expressing creativity. For example, students can follow educational pages, join communities, or learn about scholarships and events. For older people, social media can help reduce isolation by keeping them connected to family members and old friends. However, younger people may also be more vulnerable to comparison, distraction, and unrealistic standards. So I would say social media is beneficial for both age groups, but younger users may need more guidance in how to use it healthily. Some people believe that social media can help people stay connected, while others think it can lead to feelings of isolation. What are your thoughts on this? Do you agree or disagree? Why? I think both views are true, depending on how people use social media. It can help people stay connected when they use it to communicate meaningfully, share updates, or support each other. For example, someone living far from family can use social media to feel closer to them. However, it can also create isolation if people mainly compare their lives to others or replace real conversations with passive scrolling. Seeing only the best parts of other people's lives can make someone feel lonely or inadequate. So the platform itself is not the whole problem; the way people use it matters much more. Finally, do you think social media use will continue to grow in the future, or will people start to limit their usage? What factors do you think will most affect future usage of social media? Explain your thoughts. I think social media will continue to grow, but people may become more selective about how they use it. The main reason is that social media is now connected to entertainment, business, education, news, and personal communication, so it is unlikely to disappear. However, more people are becoming aware of screen addiction, misinformation, and mental health effects. Because of that, they may set limits, turn off notifications, or choose platforms that feel more useful and less stressful. I think future usage will depend on three factors: privacy, mental health, and the quality of content. People will still use social media, but they may expect more control over it.

Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about your food preferences. First, in your opinion, what kinds of meals do people your age enjoy most? Are they traditional, modern, or something in between? And what kind of meals do you usually have on busy days—do you cook, eat out, or pick up something ready-made? Many people say that modern life has changed how we eat. Do you think people today have healthier eating habits than in the past? Why or why not? I just have one more question. Some people believe that preparing traditional meals at home is an important way to stay connected to one's culture. Do you agree, or do you think it's possible to connect with culture in other ways? Why?

29 Speaking Practice Set #29

TOEFL ZONE

I'd like to ask you some questions about career choices. First, from what you've seen, what kinds of careers do people around you tend to pursue? For example, do they work in healthcare, education, technology, or something else? When choosing a career, is job satisfaction your first priority, or do you focus more on salary? Why? In recent years, there has been a trend towards people changing careers multiple times throughout their lives instead of sticking to one profession. What are your thoughts on this trend? Do you think it's helpful or hurtful to workers? Some people believe that artificial intelligence will greatly change the kinds of jobs available in the future. Do you think this trend will continue in your chosen field? Why or why not?

30 Speaking Practice Set #30

TOEFL ZONE

I have some questions about your outdoor activities. First, what kind of outdoor sports do you or your friends generally like to do? For example, do you like hiking, cycling, tennis, or other types of sport. When you participate in your favorite outdoor activity, do you prefer to do it alone or do you like to do it together with your family or friends? Why? Next, I'd like to get your opinion. Where I live outdoor activities are becoming increasingly popular. Do you think that in the place you live, the popularity of outdoor activities will increase in the future? Why or why not? I just have one more question. Some people believe that outdoor activities are essential for children's physical and mental health. Do you agree with this idea, or do you think indoor activities can be just as beneficial for children? Explain why you think so.

First, have your family or friends ever traveled to see a sporting event? For example, have they traveled to see a football game, basketball game, or other types of sports? Why or why not? Some of my friends have traveled to see sporting events, especially football matches. They enjoy the atmosphere because watching a game in a stadium feels very different from watching it on television. The crowd, the noise, and the shared excitement make the experience more memorable. Personally, I have not traveled only for a sporting event, but I understand why people do it. For many fans, the event is not just about the game; it is also about spending time with friends, supporting a team, and experiencing something live. When you travel, do you prefer to plan the details of your trip in advance, or do you prefer to be spontaneous and explore your destination without sticking to a plan? Why? I prefer to plan the important details in advance, but leave some free time for spontaneous activities. The reason is that planning reduces stress, especially when it comes to transportation, accommodation, and major attractions. If I do not plan those things, I may waste time or spend more money than necessary. However, I do not like planning every hour because it can make the trip feel like a strict schedule. Some of the best travel experiences happen unexpectedly, such as finding a small café, walking through a local market, or talking to people. So I prefer a balanced approach. Next, I'd like to get your opinion. In recent years there has been a trend towards eco-friendly travel, where people try to minimize their environmental impact while traveling, like using public transportation instead of taking a taxi. Do you think that in the future more people will adopt eco-friendly travel habits? Why or why not? Yes, I think more people will adopt eco-friendly travel habits, but only if those habits are convenient and affordable. Many people care about the environment, but when they travel, they also think about time, comfort, and cost. For example, if public transportation is reliable and easy to use, travelers may choose it instead of taxis. But if it is confusing or unsafe, they will probably choose the easier option. I also think younger travelers are becoming more aware of climate issues, so they may prefer trains, shared transportation, or local experiences. Still, eco-friendly travel needs support from cities and travel companies to become common. I just have one more question. Some people believe that traveling is essential for building confidence and independence. Do you agree with this idea, or do you think there are other ways to develop these qualities? Explain why you think so. I agree that traveling can build confidence and independence, but I do not think it is the only way. Travel forces people to solve practical problems, such as finding directions, managing money, communicating with strangers, and adapting to unfamiliar situations. These experiences can make a person more confident because they realize they can handle challenges outside their comfort zone. However, people can also develop independence through studying away from home, working, volunteering, or taking responsibility for family duties. So travel is a powerful way to grow, but the real source of confidence is facing new responsibilities and learning how to manage them.

I'd like to ask you some questions about your reading habits. First, what kind of books do your family or friends generally like to read? For example, do they prefer fiction, nonfiction, biographies, or other types? When you read your favorite book, do you prefer to read it in a quiet place, or do you like to read it where there's some background noise? Why? Next, I'd like to get your opinion. If you have time to read one novel, do you think it more worthwhile to read an old classic than many readers love, or would you choose a newly published novel that tells a modern story? Why? I just have one more question. Some people believe that reading helps improve one's imagination and creativity. Do you agree with this idea, or do you think there are other activities that can also enhance these skills? Explain why you think so.

Today I'd like to ask you some questions about your dietary habits. When you have a meal at school or work, do you prefer to eat alone, or do you like to eat with friends or coworkers? Why? When I have a meal at school or work, I usually prefer eating with friends or coworkers if I have enough time. The reason is that meals can be a good opportunity to relax and have informal conversations. After several hours of studying or working, talking to someone during lunch can improve my mood and make the day feel less stressful. However, if I am very tired or have a deadline, I sometimes prefer eating alone because it gives me a quiet break. So it depends on the situation, but generally I enjoy sharing meals with others. And what kind of meals do your family or friends generally like to eat? For example, do they prefer traditional home cooked dishes, fast food, or other types? My family generally prefers traditional home-cooked meals, while some of my friends are more open to fast food or modern dishes. In my family, food is connected to comfort and culture, so traditional meals feel more meaningful. They are usually healthier as well, because we know what ingredients are used. My friends, on the other hand, often choose fast food when they are busy because it is quick and convenient. I think this difference is common: people may prefer home-cooked food emotionally, but modern life sometimes pushes them toward faster options. Next, I'd like to get your opinion. In recent years, many people have argued that plant-based diets are better for individual health and for the planet. Do you think that in the future more people will adopt plant-based diets? Why or why not? Yes, I think more people will include plant-based meals in their diets, but I do not think everyone will become fully vegetarian or vegan. The reason is that many people are becoming more aware of health and environmental issues, but food habits are also deeply connected to culture, taste, and family traditions. For example, someone may not want to give up meat completely, but they may choose plant-based meals a few times a week. This is more realistic for most people. I think the trend will grow if plant-based options become affordable, tasty, and easy to find. I just have one more question. Some people believe that having regular mealtimes contributes to better health and financial well-being. Do you agree or disagree with this idea? Explain your answer. I agree that regular mealtimes can contribute to both better health and better financial habits. When people eat at regular times, they are less likely to skip meals and then make unhealthy choices because they are too hungry. It can also help with energy levels and concentration during the day. From a financial point of view, regular mealtimes often encourage people to plan meals in advance, cook at home, and avoid last-minute spending on expensive takeout. Of course, not everyone can follow a perfect schedule, but even a simple routine can make eating habits healthier and more affordable.

34 Speaking Practice Set #34

TOEFL ZONE

I'd like to ask you some questions about your exercise habits. What kind of exercise do you or your friends like? For example, do you like running, swimming, yoga, or other types? When you exercise, do you prefer to do it alone, or do you like to exercise with other people? Why? Next, I'd like to get your opinion. In the past, most people exercised outdoors, but now many people prefer indoor gyms and fitness centers. Do you think that in the future, indoor gyms will become even more popular? Why or why not? I just have one more question. Some people believe that exercising regularly is essential for developing self-discipline. Do you agree with this idea? Or do you think there are other activities that can also help build discipline? Explain your answer.

35 Speaking Practice Set #35

TOEFL ZONE

Thank you for taking the time to speak with me about your hobbies and leisure activities. First, when you engage in your favorite hobby, do you prefer to do it alone or do you like to do it with your family or friends? Why? And do you think it is better to spend free time indoors like in a movie theater or outdoors like in a park? Why? Next, I'd like to get your opinion. Many people have the same hobbies as their friends. Do you think it is necessary for good friends to share hobbies? Why or why not? I just have one more question. Some people believe that having hobbies is essential for being happy. Do you agree with this idea, or do you think you can live a happy life without having hobbies? Explain your answer.